

Juan Pablo de Legarreta
NETC-240
Lab 12 – 4-9-2025

eDiscovery Scenario Characters:

Employee	John	Tim	Krystal	Sarah
Title	Head of HR	Salesman	Sales Manager	Secretary
Role in scenario	Investigator	Suspect 1	Suspect 2	Whistleblower
MS365 acct:	E5	F3	CinState	N/A

eDiscovery Scenario Plot:

John, Tim, Krystal, and Sarah work at an exciting and fast-growing tech startup (Advance Corp) that specializes in AI-powered analytics. The company has a reputation for aggressive sales and generous **commissions**, especially for large customers that are internally referred to as **whales**. Tami, the secretary of the sales department, has heard whispers of '**padding** numbers' and '**ghosts**' in conversations between Krystal and Tim, and has grown concerned that they are lying about their sales. Tim has been coming in lately dressed in new suits and showing off expensive watches. Krystal recently took her family on an impromptu vacation to Australia with a stopover in Tokyo on a lavish two-week trip.

Finally, Sarah was asked to make copies of a signed **contract** for a huge \$1.2 million deal that Tim had closed with Krystal's help. The signature from the client seemed off somehow. Sarah's suspicion led her to search through other recent contracts and she found a legitimate contract from the previous week whose handwritten portions (dates, initials, etc.) were an exact match for the one she was holding, but the company name, dollar amount, and signatures were different. What's worse, these details did not match the handwriting or color of the rest of the contract, and she suspected that it had been forged somehow.

Another detail that struck her as suspicious was that she recognized the company (**Westward Exploration Group**) who had signed the contract – she had handled a phone call with them a few months ago where they asked her to let Krystal know they were heading in a different direction. A sudden and dramatic change of heart seemed highly unlikely. Armed with the evidence, she sets up a meeting with John to report the issues.

John quietly begins an investigation. He quickly finds messages between Krystal and Tim with seemingly intentional misspellings and terms, such as 'the dubs' referring to (John suspects) the "W" in Westward Exploration Group, 'commish' for commission, or 'gost' for ghost. It seems like they are trying to hide their tracks by

utilizing these 'mistakes'. John adds the keywords to his search and begins to uncover more...

Scenario Keywords and Communications:

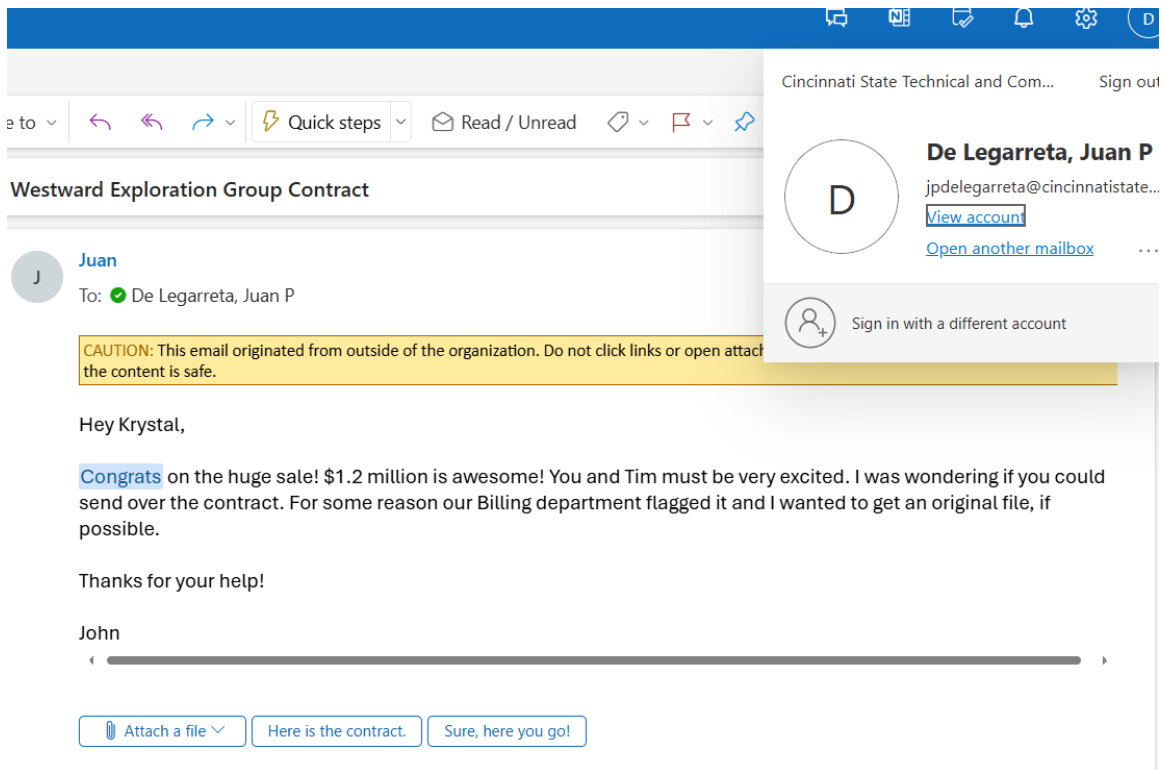
The keywords regarding this eDiscovery case are bolded in the scenario above and listed (with others) below:

- **Commissions** (also **comision**, and **commish**)
- **Whale** (also **whales**)
- **Padding**
- **Ghost** (also **ghoost** and **gost**)
- **Contract**
- **Westward Exploration Group** (or abbreviated **WEG** or '**the dubs**')

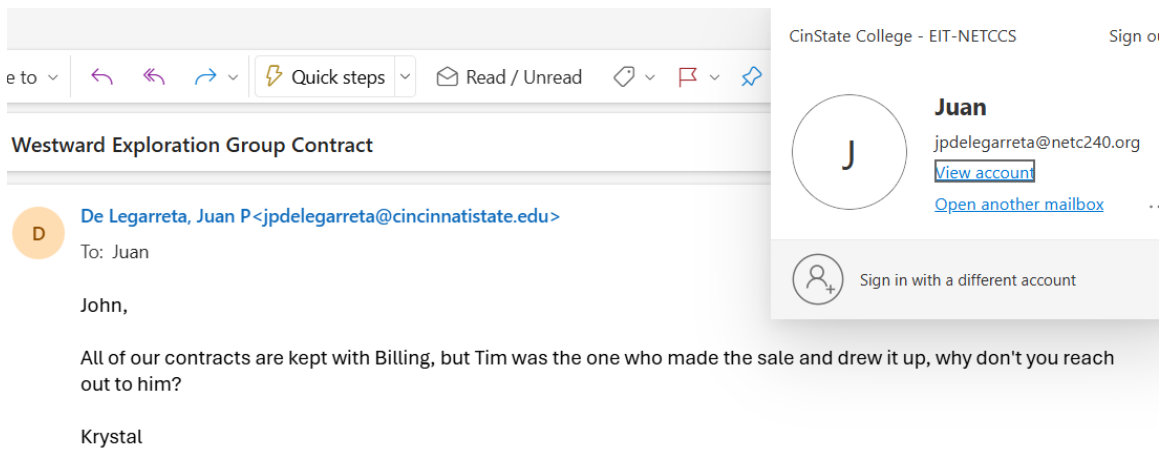
The communications most likely to produce evidence are emails between Tim and Krystal as well as Teams messages. There are also documents that are important to consider, such as the contracts themselves.

1. For your scenario, send yourself at least 4 emails between your E5 and personal email account that will be in scope. Also create two emails that have at least one keyword, but are out of scope. In each email, pretend you are expressing a concern, responding with information and lastly indicating that you believe some aspect of your situation isn't being handled correctly. It needs to fit the story.

In scope emails:



This email is from John to Krystal, trying to get a copy of the contract so he can see it for himself.



This is Krystal's response.

CinState College - EIT-NETCCCS

Sign out

Reply to

Quick steps

Read / Unread

Westward Exploration Group

J

Juan

To: Student6

Tim,

Can you provide me with a copy for the WEG contract? Billing said they were having an issue with their copy.

Congrats on closing the sale!

Cheers,

John

S

Student6

student6@netc240.org

[View account](#)

[Open another mailbox](#)

Sign in with a different account

John sends an email to Tim to continue investigating and trying to get a copy of the document himself.

CinState College - EIT-NETCCS

Sign out

Reply to

Quick steps

Read / Unread

Westward Exploration Group

S

Student6

To: Juan

Hey John,

I don't have a copy - did you check with Krystal? Also, Billing usually has a mix-up. Tell them to review it again.

Tim

...

Yes, I will check.

Will do, thanks!

Just forwarded it to you.

Reply

Forward

J

Juan

jpdelegarreta@netc240.org

[View account](#)

[Open another mailbox](#)

Sign in with a different account

Tim's response.

Send

To

Student6 X jpdelegarreta@cincinnati.state.edu

Bcc

Cc

Concern over the WEG Contract

Draft saved at 2:55 PM

Tim and Krystal,

There seems to be a rather pressing issue with the contract for Westward Exploration Group... I am starting to get concerned since neither of you have given me a direct answer about this issue. If I don't get an answer from either of you to explain the situation, I am going to have to involve legal.

What is going on?

John

John’s escalating the situation and trying to get an answer out of Krystal and Tim

Search

help

delete Archive Report Sweep Move to Quick steps Read / Unread

Focused Other

Today

Student6

HE KNOWS

2:57 PM

You don't often get email from st...

Juan

Concern over the WEG ...

2:55 PM

CAUTION: This email originated f...

Juan

Westward Exploration ...

2:46 PM

CAUTION: This email originated f...

HE KNOWS

S

Student6 <student6@netc240.org>

To: De Legarreta, Juan P

Wed 4/16/2025 2:57 PM

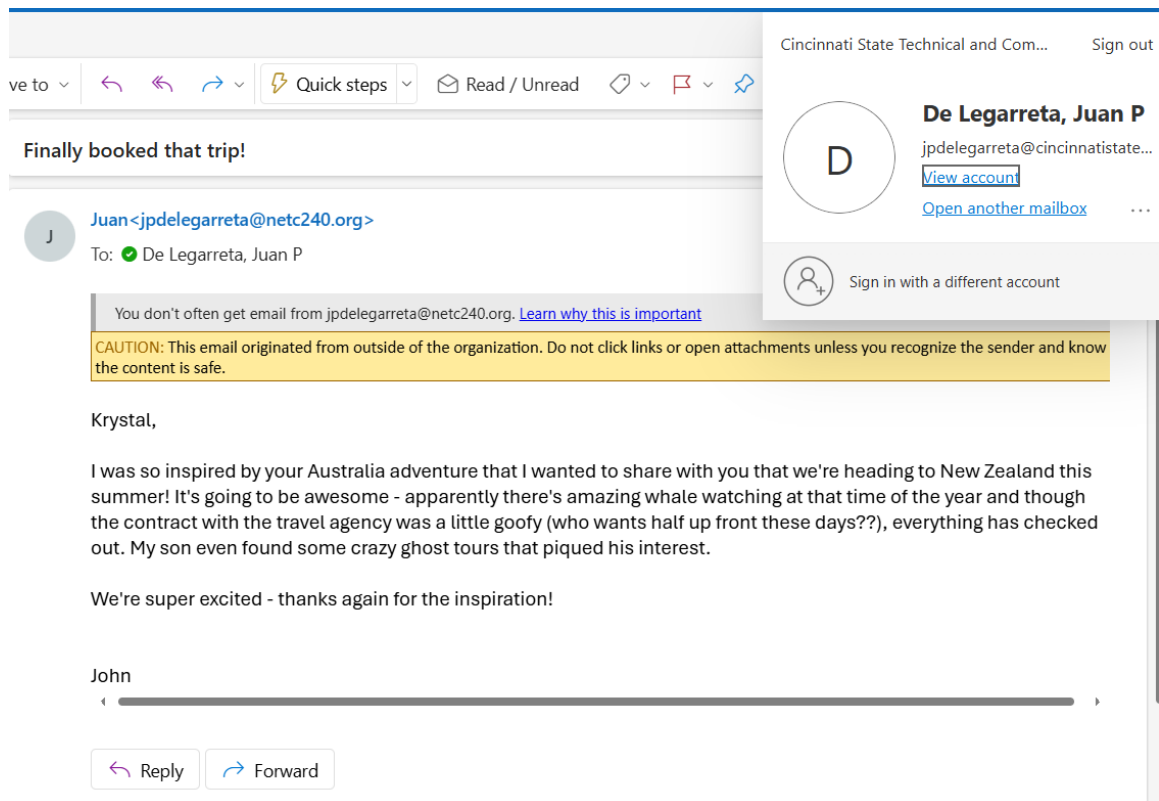
You don't often get email from student6@netc240.org. [Learn why this is important](#)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

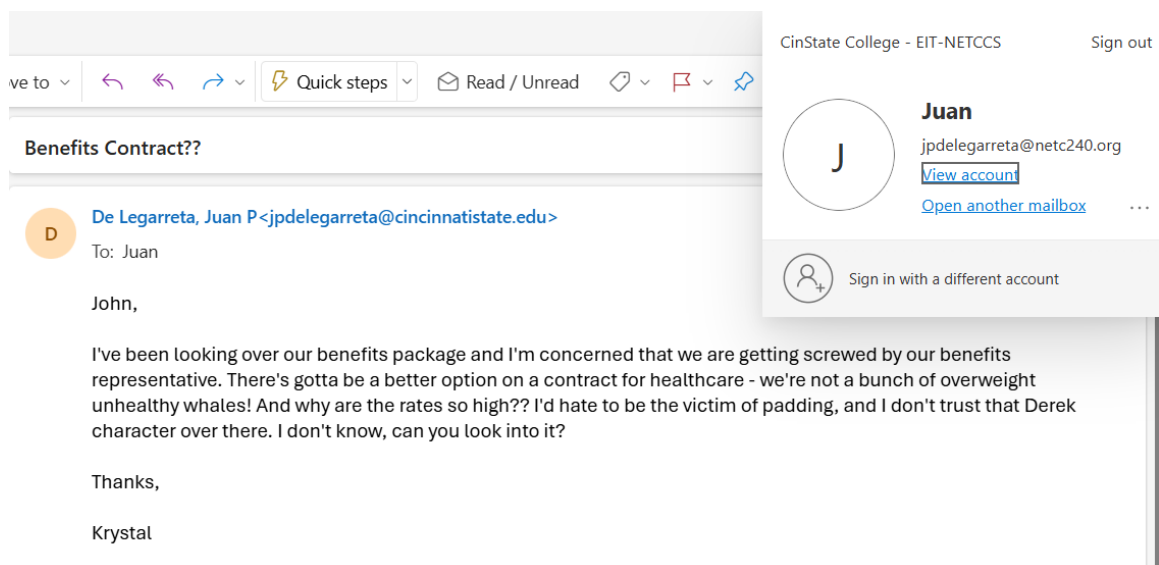
What are we going to do? This whale harpoon was supposed to be our ticket to retirement! This contract was EVERYTHING! YOU SAID THE DUBS WAS SECURE. What the hell are we going to do?

Tim’s panicked email to Krystal about the situation.

Out of scope emails:



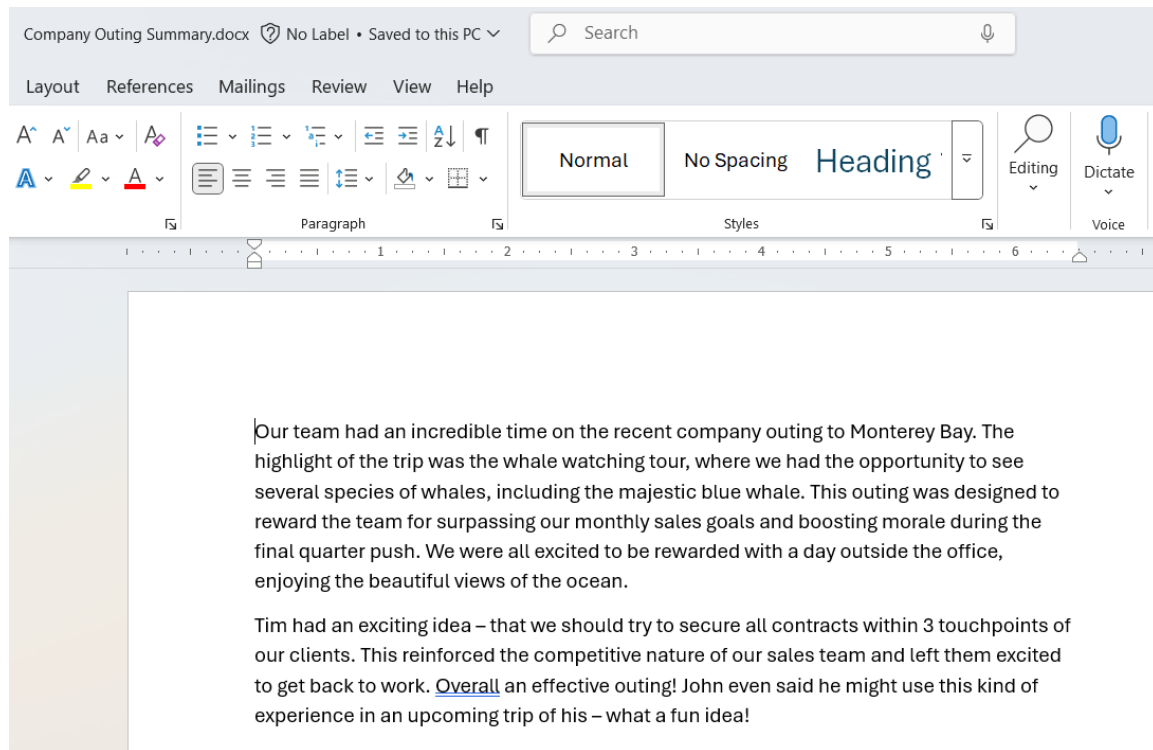
This email was sent from 'John' (E5) to 'Krystal' (College account) about a trip, including key words 'whale', 'contract', and 'ghost'. It's out of scope as it has nothing to do with work.



This email was sent from 'Krystal' (college account) to 'John' (E5 account) about benefits, a normal conversation between an employee and HR that is outside the scope of this eDiscovery process, though it contains the keywords 'contract', 'whale', and 'padding'.

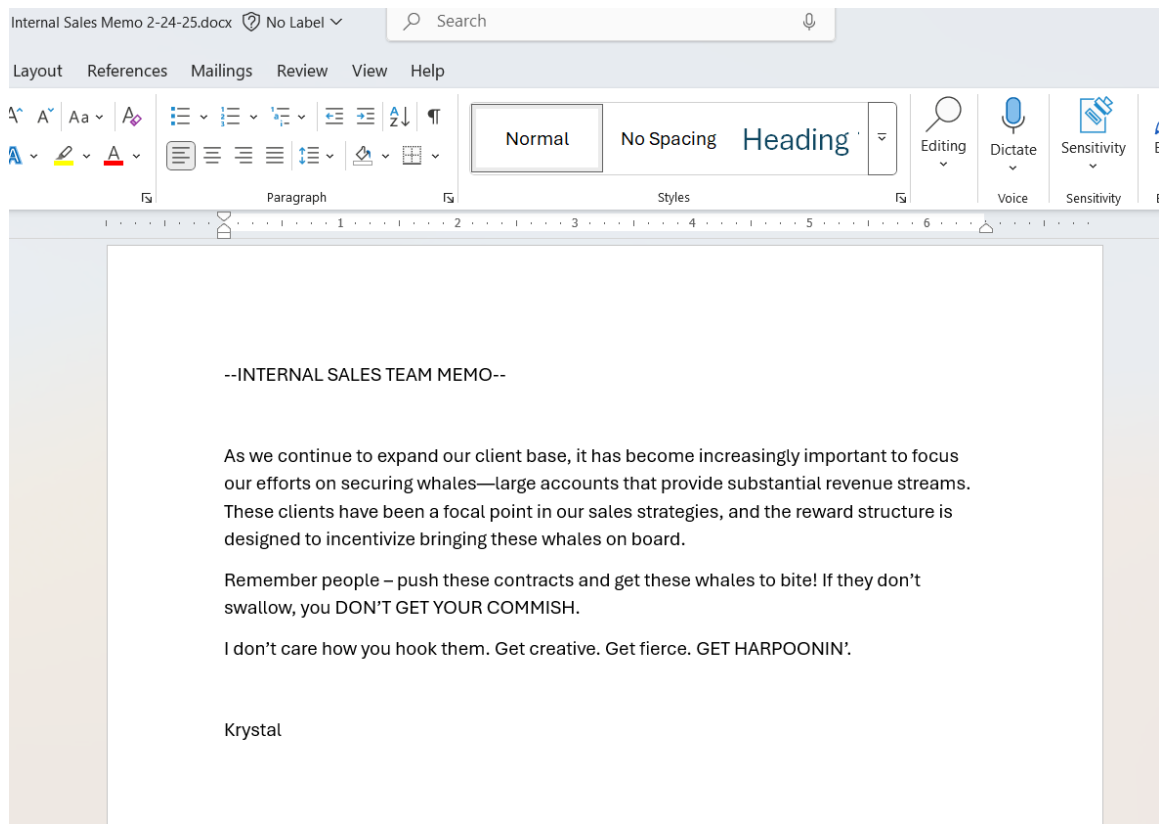
2. Create 3 Word documents that you need to save in your SharePoint site. Two of the documents should be crafted to ensure that they are identified in the eDiscovery process. The third document should include several of the keywords, but not be in scope and therefore not be included in the search results. Again, the documents should have multiple sentences, context, etc. Avoid trivial documents (i.e. just a search term, etc.).

Out of scope:

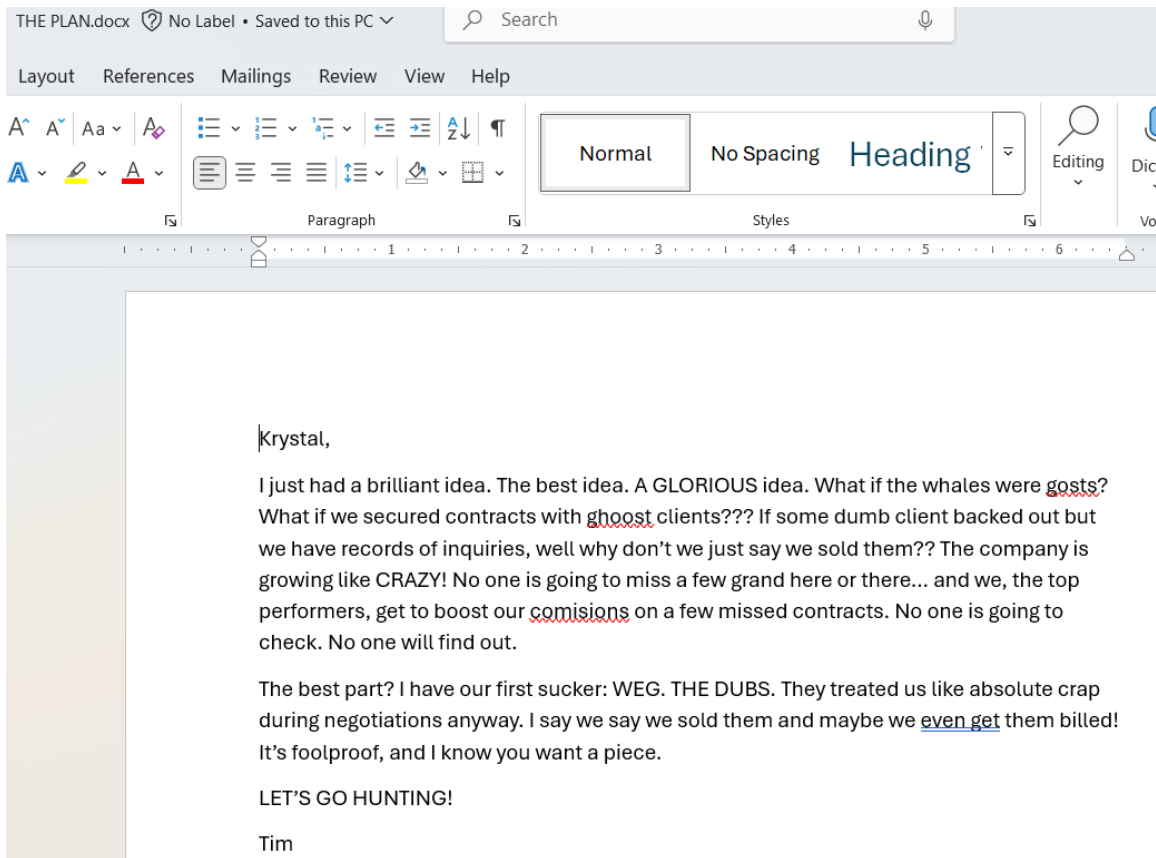


This document is a summary of a company outing. It's not related to the investigation and is the one document with keywords that is out of scope.

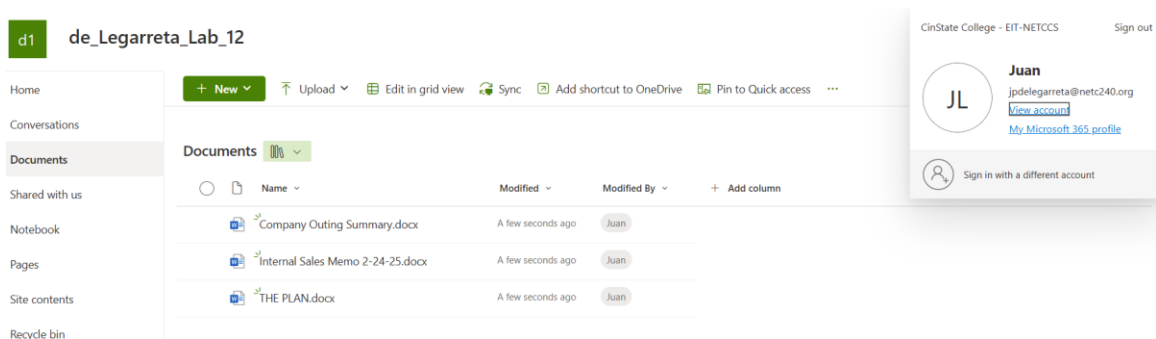
In scope:



This is a memo to the whole sales team from Krystal. It's got key words that show the incentive to push out contracts no matter the cost. It also lays the groundwork for how outside of the rules Krystal is operating.



This from Tim to Krystal, dubbed 'THE PLAN', shows the strategy plainly.



Here you can see all three documents on a SharePoint site named de_Legarreta_Lab_12.

3. Use eDiscovery to collect Electronically Stored Information (ESI) related to the case

a. Collect data from all sources, except previous "holds"

Microsoft Purview

Search

Copilot

CinState College - EIT-NETCCS Sign out

eDiscovery

- Overview
- Cases
- Content Search
- Classic eDiscovery
- Standard Cases**
- Premium Cases
- Content Search

Related solutions

- Audit

eDiscovery (Standard)

After creating an eDiscovery case and choosing who has access to it, use the case to search for email, documents, Skype for Business conversations, and other content in your organization. You can then preserve the content and export the search results for further analysis. [Learn more](#)

ⓘ This page is being retired in August 2025. You can now manage all your cases in our new, unified eDiscovery experience. This faster and easier-to-use experience includes new premium features, offering a simpler workflow with robust reporting. Start using the improved experience today to enjoy these new capabilities. [Learn more about the new experience.](#)

[Go to the new eDiscovery](#)

+ Create a case ↓ Export list ↻ Refresh 16 items Search Group Filter Customize columns

Name	Status	Created date	Last modified	Last modified by
☐ Well-Path Investigation	Active	Apr 16, 2025 9:37 AM	Apr 16, 2025 9:37 AM	Taoficath Laye
☐ AJ Lab Case	Active	Apr 16, 2025 9:34 AM	Apr 16, 2025 9:34 AM	Jacob

I am logged into my E5 account and about to start the eDiscovery process.

Microsoft Purview

Search

eDiscovery

- Overview
- Cases
- Content Search
- Classic eDiscovery
- Standard Cases**
- Premium Cases
- Content Search

Related solutions

- Audit

eDiscovery (Standard) > **de_Legarreta_Lab_12**

Home Searches Hold Exports Settings

de_Legarreta_Lab_12

Created
2025-04-16T19:00:02.033333Z

Status
Active

Description
An investigation into the WEG contract and potential padding of numbers by Krystal and Tim.

Here is the case de_Legarreta_Lab_12, where we will investigate the situation.

Microsoft Purview

Search

New search

- Name and description**
- Locations
- Conditions
- Review your search

Name and description

Name

first_search

Description

This is the first search according to step 3a of Lab 12

I am creating a search according to the instructions.

Locations

☒ Specific locations

Status	Location	Included	Excluded
☒ On	Exchange mailboxes Microsoft 365 Groups Teams Yammer user messages	All Choose users, groups, or teams	None
☒ On	SharePoint sites OneDrive sites Microsoft 365 Group Sites Team Sites Yammer Networks	All Choose sites	None
☒ On	Exchange public folders	All	None

☐ Locations on hold

☒ Add App Content for On-Premises Users. [Learn more](#)

I have selected all sources except those on previous holds.

b. Create a list of search terms (keywords) and list them in a table

Keywords:

Commission	Comision	Commish	Whale	Whales	Padding	Ghost
Gost	Ghoost	Contract	Westward Exploration Group	WEG	Dubs	

c. Your eDiscovery query will need to search on several terms and exclude others. For example, if Project X is in scope, but Project Y,Z,R,Q, etc. are not, they need to be excluded using the “NOT” operator. Use the KQL editor to build your query.

Include the date range in your query

i. Your first query should be broad and capture emails and documents that are not in scope

keywords

(Commission OR comision OR commish OR whale OR whales OR padding OR ghost OR ghoost OR gost OR contract OR 'Westward Exploration Group' OR WEG OR dubs)

☐ Show keyword list

AND

Date

Between

2025-03-16

2025-04-16

AND

Participants

Equals any of

Student6

Juan

Choose users

Back

Next

Cancel

Name and description

Name

first_search

Description

This is the first search according to step 3a of Lab 12

[Edit name and description](#)

Search criteria

(Commission OR comision OR commish OR whale OR whales OR padding OR ghost OR ghoost OR gost OR contract OR 'Westward Exploration Group' OR WEG OR dubs) (c:c)(date=2025-03-16..2025-04-16)(participants=student6@netc240.org)(participants=jpdelegarreta@netc240.org)

[Edit search criteria](#)

Locations

SharePoint

Enabled

Exchange

Enabled

Exchange public folders

Enabled

[Edit locations](#)

Here are the parameters of the first query. They include dates and include everything. It should capture all of the documents and emails sent.

- ii. **Your second query is focused on finding materials in scope. Include two different compound search terms, one**

that uses a combination of AND/OR, the other that also incorporate NOT

Name and description

Name

second_search

Description

A second, more detailed search.

[Edit name and description](#)

Search criteria

(Commission OR comision OR commish OR whale OR whales OR padding OR ghost OR ghoost OR gost OR contract OR 'Westward Exploration Group' OR WEG OR dubs) AND NOT (Outing) AND (date=2025-04-14..2025-04-16) AND (participants=student6@netc240.org) OR (participants=jpdelegarreta@netc240.org)

[Edit search criteria](#)

Locations

SharePoint

Enabled

Exchange

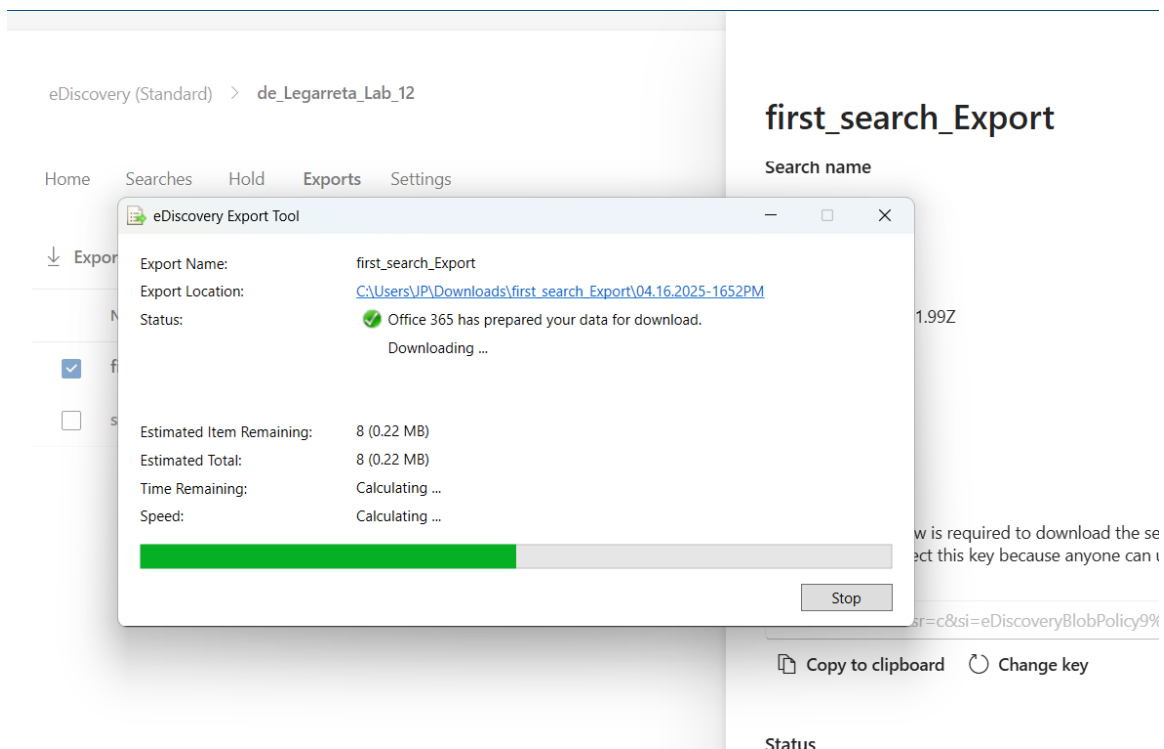
Enabled

Exchange public folders

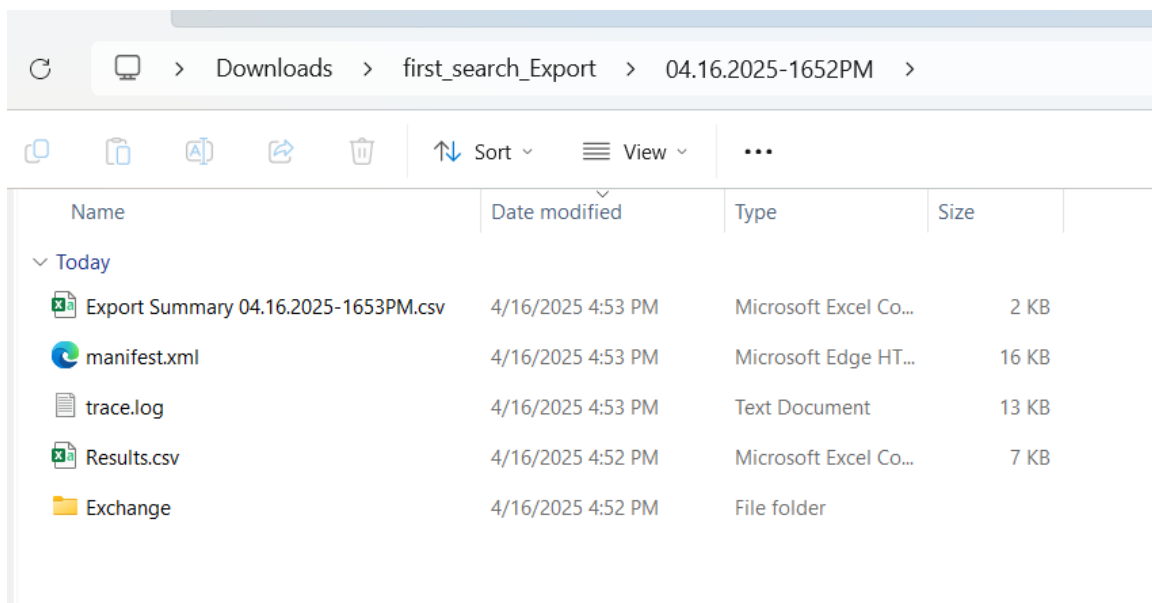
Enabled

The second search, including multiple compound search terms, one with NOT, and multiple with AND/OR

- d. Show the list of documents found in the search (Export). For emails, export the individual messages (not PST)**
 - iii. Include a screenshot of each of the document contents**
- e. Include copies of the emails that were found**



I downloaded the exported files.



They saved in my Downloads folder, containing two csv files, one xml, one log file, and the emails in the Exchange folder.

AutoSave

Off

Export Summary 04.16.2025-1653P...

Saved to this PC

File

Home

Insert

Page Layout

Formulas

Data

Review

View

Automate

Help

Paste

Clipboard

Aptos Narrow

11

A[^]

A^v

B

I

U

Font

Alignment

A1

✕

✓

fx

Export Name

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J														
1	Export Name	first_search_Export																						
2	Export ID	3a8400f6-0f39-4e7a-28d1-08dd7d27005f																						
3	Status	The download completed successfully.																						
4	De-Duplicate	No																						
5	Export Location	C:\Users\JP\Downloads\first_search_Export\04.16.2025-1652PM																						
6	Remove RINOs																							
7	Location with	2																						
8	Location without	2																						
9	Locations that are not	0																						
10																								
11		Items	Size(GB)	Size(Bytes)																				
12	Estimated	8	0	232,872																				
13	Exchange file	8	0	232,872																				
14	Downloaded	8	0	232,872																				
15																								
16	Item Downloaded	0																						
17	Item Downloaded	0																						
18	Item Skipped	0																						
19																								
20	SharePoint	0																						
21	SharePoint	0																						
22	SharePoint	0																						
23	SharePoint	0																						
24	SharePoint	0																						
25	Download	#####																						
26	Download	#####																						
27																								
28	Locations that are not	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0														

<

>

Export Summary 04.16.2025-1653P

+

This was in the file named Export Summary

AutoSave Off

Results.csv

Saved to this PC

Search

FileHomeInsertPage LayoutFormulasDataReviewViewAutomateHelp

PasteClipboard

Font

Alignment

Number

Styles

Cells

Editing

Sensitivity

Add-ins

Analyze Data

Comments

Share

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W								
1	ExportItem	Ident	Document	Selected	Duplicate	Original	Pa	Location	Location	N	Target	Part	Document	Subject	Sender	or (	Recipients	Recipients	Recipients	To -	Expan	CC -	Expr	DG	Expan	Sent	Has	Attach	Importanc	Is	Read
2	14006E0F	Exchange	1175357					student6@	student6@	student6@	Exchange	student6@	Re: Westw	Student6	<	Juan	<	jpdelegarreta@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE		
3	8B9CAD00	Exchange	1226385					jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	Exchange	jpdelegarri	Westward	Juan	</O=	Student6	<	student6@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE		
4	8B1B2A47	Exchange	1226389					jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	Exchange	jpdelegarri	Concern	o	Juan	</O=	Student6	<	student6@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE	
5	A5E5AE4F	Exchange	1226377					jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	Exchange	jpdelegarri	Westward	Juan	</O=	jpdelegarreta@cincinnati										#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE		
6	8B9CAD00	Exchange	1175352					student6@	student6@	student6@	Exchange	student6@	Westward	Juan	<	jpde	Student6	<	student6@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE	
7	8B1B2A47	Exchange	1175358					student6@	student6@	student6@	Exchange	student6@	Concern	o	Juan	<	jpde	Student6	<	student6@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE
8	14006E0F	Exchange	1226386					jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	Exchange	jpdelegarri	Re: Westw	Student6	<	Juan	<	jpdelegarreta@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE		
9	794068AD	Exchange	1226382					jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	jpdelegarri	Exchange	jpdelegarri	Re: Westw	"De	Legar	Juan	<	jpdelegarreta@netc240.org								#####	FALSE	Normal	TRUE		

This is the file called Results

Home | Microsoft 365 Copilot | de_Legarreta_Lab_12 | Microsoft | manifest.xml

File | C:/Users/JP/Downloads/first_search_Export/04.16.2025-1652PM/manifest.xml

This XML file does not appear to have any style information associated with it. The document tree is shown below.

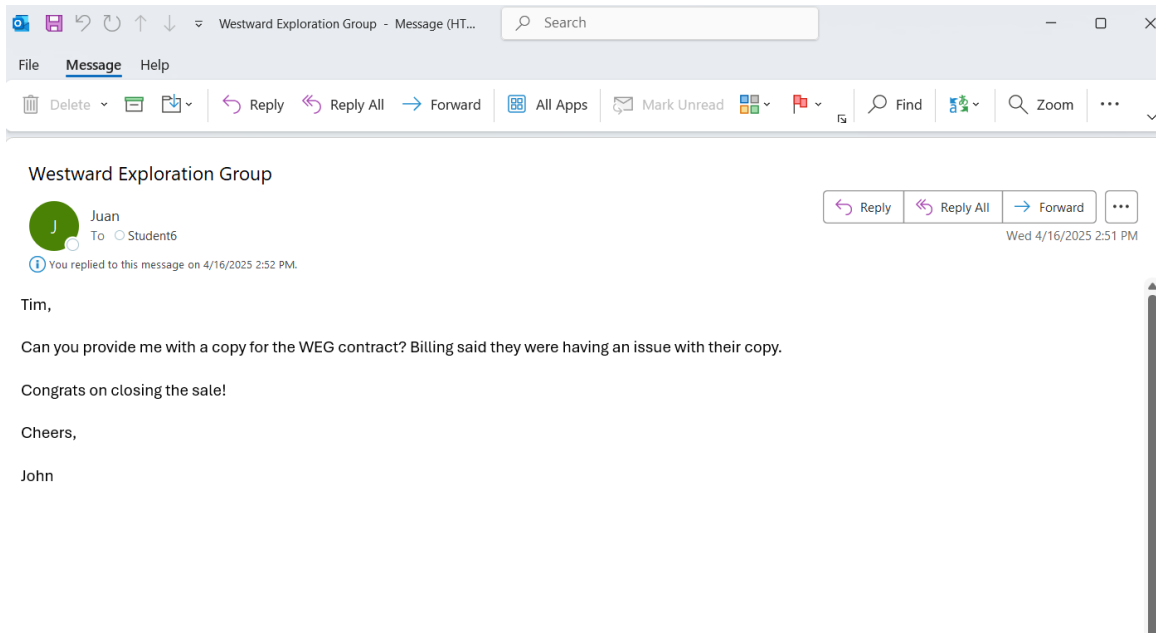
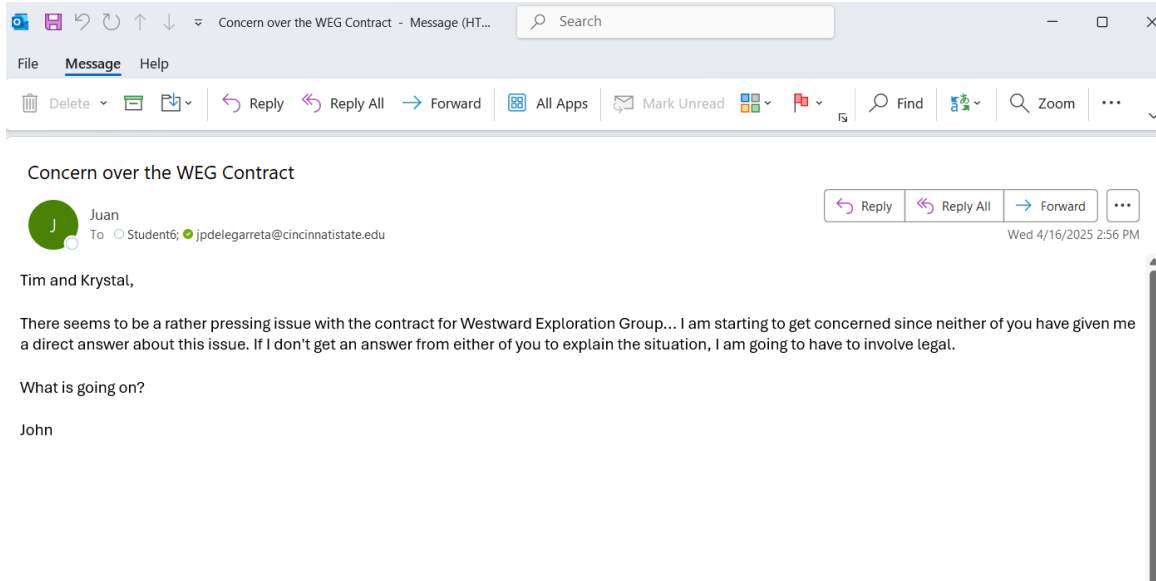
```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8" standalone="yes" xmlns:xsi="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema-instance" xmlns:xsd="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema" MajorVersion="1" MinorVersion="1" Description="first_search_Export" DataInterchangeType="Update" CaseId="">
  <Batch>
    <Documents>
      <Document DocId="Exchange\student6@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items\Re\3A Westward Exploration Group.msg" DocType="Message" MimeType="application/vnd.ms-outlook">
        <Tags>
          <Tag TagName="TargetPath" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Exchange\student6@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items\Re\3A Westward Exploration Group.msg"/>
          <Tag TagName="Subject" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Re: Westward Exploration Group"/>
          <Tag TagName="DateSent" TagDataType="DateTime" TagValue="2025-04-16T18:52:13"/>
          <Tag TagName="DateReceived" TagDataType="DateTime" TagValue="2025-04-16T18:52:14"/>
          <Tag TagName="From" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Student6 <student6@netc240.org>"/>
          <Tag TagName="To" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Juan <jpdelegarreta@netc240.org>;"/>
          <Tag TagName="BCC" TagDataType="Text" TagValue=""/>
          <Tag TagName="HasAttachments" TagDataType="Boolean" TagValue="False"/>
          <Tag TagName="ImportanceFlag" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Normal"/>
          <Tag TagName="ReadFlag" TagDataType="Boolean" TagValue="True"/>
          <Tag TagName="Size" TagDataType="LongInteger" TagValue="12033"/>
          <Tag TagName="Source" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="student6@netc240.org"/>
          <Tag TagName="OriginalUrl" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="student6@netc240.org, Primary, dclaba60-9504-4f38-be05-49b8cabd14ef\Exchange\student6@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items"/>
          <Tag TagName="CreatedOn" TagDataType="DateTime" TagValue="2025-04-16T18:52:14"/>
        </Tags>
        <Locations>
          <Location>
            <Custodian>student6@netc240.org, Primary, dclaba60-9504-4f38-be05-49b8cabd14ef</Custodian>
            <LocationURI>student6@netc240.org, Primary, dclaba60-9504-4f38-be05-49b8cabd14ef\Exchange\student6@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items\LocationURI>
            <Description>None/Description>
          </Location>
        </Locations>
      </Document>
      <Document DocId="Exchange\jpdelegarreta@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items\Westward Exploration Group.msg" DocType="Message" MimeType="application/vnd.ms-outlook">
        <Tags>
          <Tag TagName="TargetPath" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Exchange\jpdelegarreta@netc240.org (Primary)\Top of Information Store\Sent Items\Westward Exploration Group.msg"/>
          <Tag TagName="Subject" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Westward Exploration Group"/>
          <Tag TagName="DateSent" TagDataType="DateTime" TagValue="2025-04-16T18:50:43"/>
          <Tag TagName="DateReceived" TagDataType="DateTime" TagValue="2025-04-16T18:50:44"/>
          <Tag TagName="From" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Juan </O=EXCHANGE LABS\OU=EXCHANGE ADMINISTRATIVE GROUP (FYDIBOHF23SPDLT)/CN=RECIPIENTS/CN=2B2A4B6ED3744C18C4E0525F7669CC5-51C1DCB9-EF>"/>
          <Tag TagName="To" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Student6 <student6@netc240.org>;"/>
          <Tag TagName="BCC" TagDataType="Text" TagValue=""/>
          <Tag TagName="HasAttachments" TagDataType="Boolean" TagValue="False"/>
          <Tag TagName="ImportanceFlag" TagDataType="Text" TagValue="Normal"/>
          <Tag TagName="ReadFlag" TagDataType="Boolean" TagValue="True"/>
        </Tags>
      </Document>
    </Documents>
  </Batch>
</?xml>
```

A file called manifest.xml opened up a web page, seen above.

student6@netc240.org (Primary) > Top of Information Store > Inbox

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
Today			
Concern over the WEG Contract.msg	4/16/2025 2:55 PM	Outlook.File.msg.15	71 KB
Westward Exploration Group.msg	4/16/2025 2:50 PM	Outlook.File.msg.15	72 KB

Here are the emails for the F3 (Tim) account in the Inbox folder.



The following emails are from the E5 (John) account's inbox:

Re: Westward Exploration Group



Student6
To: Juan

[Reply](#) [Reply All](#) [Forward](#) [...](#)
Wed 4/16/2025 2:52 PM

Hey John,

I don't have a copy - did you check with Krystal? Also, Billing usually has a mix-up. Tell them to review it again.

Tim

From: Juan <jpdelegarreta@netc240.org>
Sent: Wednesday, April 16, 2025 2:50 PM
To: Student6 <student6@netc240.org>
Subject: Westward Exploration Group

Tim,

Can you provide me with a copy for the WEG contract? Billing said they were having an issue with their copy.

Congrats on closing the sale!

Cheers,

John

Re: Westward Exploration Group Contract - Message (HT...

File **Message** Help

Delete [Reply](#) [Reply All](#) [Forward](#) [All Apps](#) [Mark Unread](#) Find Zoom

Re: Westward Exploration Group Contract



De Legarreta, Juan P <jpdelegarreta@cincinnatiastate.edu>
To: Juan

[Reply](#) [Reply All](#) [Forward](#) [...](#)
Wed 4/16/2025 2:49 PM

if there are problems with how this message is displayed, click here to view it in a web browser.

John,

All of our contracts are kept with Billing, but Tim was the one who made the sale and drew it up, why don't you reach out to him?

Krystal

From: Juan <jpdelegarreta@netc240.org>
Sent: Wednesday, April 16, 2025 2:46 PM
To: De Legarreta, Juan P <jpdelegarreta@cincinnatiastate.edu>
Subject: Westward Exploration Group Contract

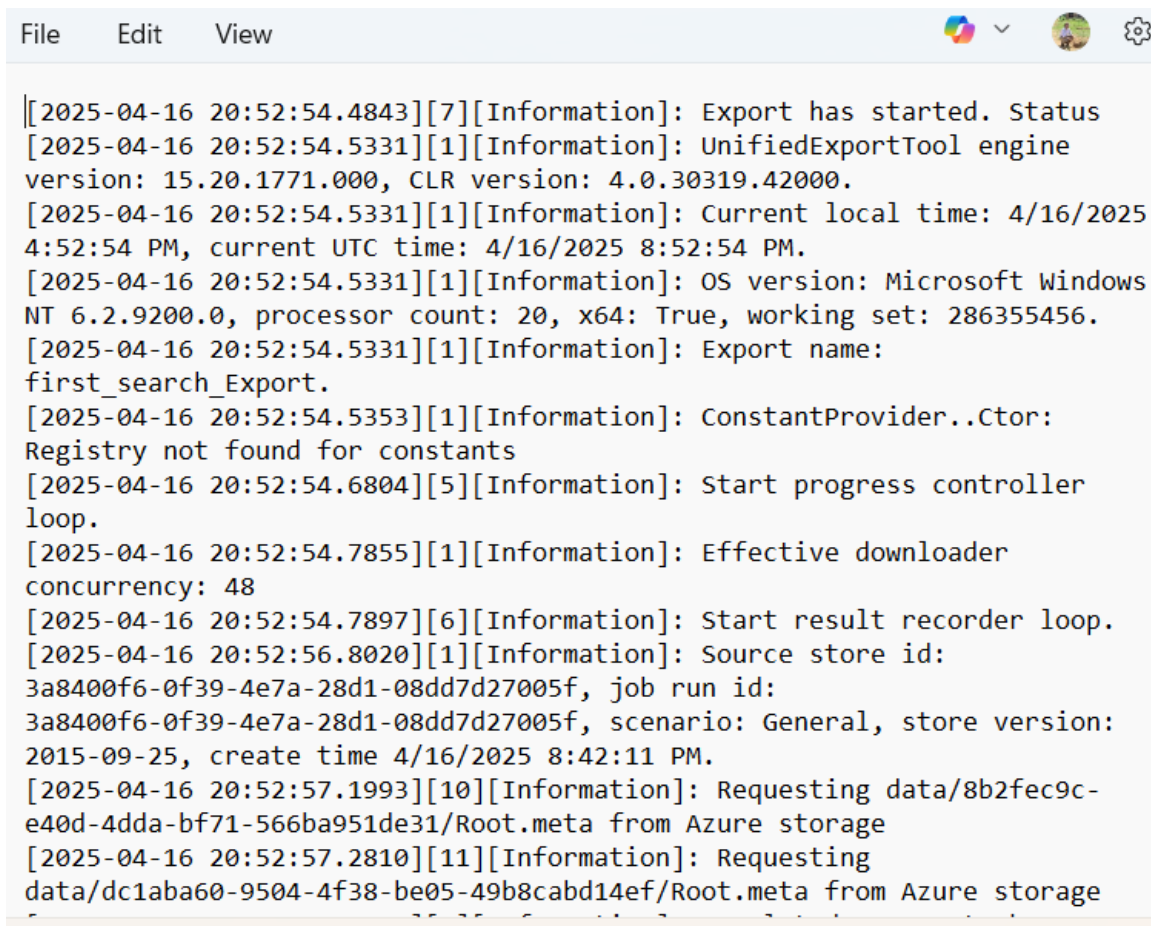
CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Hey Krystal,

Congrats on the huge sale! \$1.2 million is awesome! You and Tim must be very excited. I was wondering if you could send over the contract. For some reason our Billing department flagged it and I wanted to get an original file, if possible.

Thanks for your help!

John

A screenshot of a Windows application window. The title bar shows 'File Edit View' and standard Windows icons. The main content area displays a log of events from the UnifiedExportTool engine. The log entries are timestamped and include information about the engine version, current local and UTC times, OS version, processor count, export name, and progress controller loops. The log ends with requests for data from Azure storage.

```
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.4843][7][Information]: Export has started. Status
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.5331][1][Information]: UnifiedExportTool engine
version: 15.20.1771.000, CLR version: 4.0.30319.42000.
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.5331][1][Information]: Current local time: 4/16/2025
4:52:54 PM, current UTC time: 4/16/2025 8:52:54 PM.
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.5331][1][Information]: OS version: Microsoft Windows
NT 6.2.9200.0, processor count: 20, x64: True, working set: 286355456.
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.5331][1][Information]: Export name:
first_search_Export.
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.5353][1][Information]: ConstantProvider..Ctor:
Registry not found for constants
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.6804][5][Information]: Start progress controller
loop.
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.7855][1][Information]: Effective downloader
concurrency: 48
[2025-04-16 20:52:54.7897][6][Information]: Start result recorder loop.
[2025-04-16 20:52:56.8020][1][Information]: Source store id:
3a8400f6-0f39-4e7a-28d1-08dd7d27005f, job run id:
3a8400f6-0f39-4e7a-28d1-08dd7d27005f, scenario: General, store version:
2015-09-25, create time 4/16/2025 8:42:11 PM.
[2025-04-16 20:52:57.1993][10][Information]: Requesting data/8b2fec9c-
e40d-4dda-bf71-566ba951de31/Root.meta from Azure storage
[2025-04-16 20:52:57.2810][11][Information]: Requesting
data/dc1aba60-9504-4f38-be05-49b8cabd14ef/Root.meta from Azure storage
```

Trace.log showed the above output.

f. Show copies of the emails and documents that were not flagged

The emails and documents that were not found included all of the Word documents and the emails between Tim and Krystal, which is odd, as they should have been included... the screenshots of these are in steps 1 and 2.

4. Create an eDiscovery “Hold” on your own account. Use the same KQL statements from your 2nd query above.

New Hold

✓ Name your hold

✓ Choose locations

✓ Query

● Review your settings

Review your settings

Name
Name Lab_Hold

Description
[Edit name](#)

Choose locations

Exchange email

SharePoint sites

Exchange public folders All
[Edit locations](#)

Query
Query (Commission OR comision OR commish OR whale OR whales OR padding OR ghost OR ghoost OR gost OR contract OR 'Westward Exploration Group' OR WEG OR dubs) AND NOT (Outing) AND (date=2025-04-14..2025-04-16) AND (participants=student6@netc240.org) OR (participants=jpdelegarreta@netc240.org)
[Edit query](#)

Created a Hold on my account called Lab_Hold with the same KQL as my second search. I included both of my accounts, my E5 and F3 because I used both to send the emails.

5. Export the results of your eDiscovery query

eDiscovery (Standard) > de_Legarreta_Lab_12

Home Searches Hold Exports Settings

↓ Export list ↻ Refresh

Name	Last export start time (UTC-04:00)
☒ first_search_Export	Apr 16, 2025 4:41:01 PM
☐ second_search_Export	Apr 16, 2025 4:48:23 PM

first_search_Export

↓ Restart export ↓ Download results 🗑 Delete

Search name
first_search

Started on
2025-04-16T20:41:01.99Z

Size
8 Items, 227.41 KB

Export key
The export key below is required to download the search results. Be sure to take precautions to protect this key because anyone can use it to download these results.

I have exported the results of both queries.

Q1. Write the KQL statement that will select all materials that include the keywords (merger, due diligence, disclosure, hidden) that occur between two different dates. Do not select any item that has the term BOT in it.

(merger OR "due diligence" OR disclosure OR hidden) AND (Received>=2024-01-01 AND Received<=2024-12-31) AND NOT BOT

Q2. What is a PST file and how is it used?

A PST or Personal Storage Table file is a file that contains emails, contacts, calendar events, and other information usually associated with Microsoft Outlook. This kind of file can be used to store emails and associated information outside of the application. These files can be useful because they preserve information that may be subject to retention/deletion policies at a workplace, giving an archive to those who would benefit from referencing conversations that go past the timeframe of retention/deletion.

Source:

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/importing-pst-files-to-office-365>

Q3. What is de-duplication. Provide an example where it would be beneficial

De-duplication means eliminating duplicate copies of data or files to reduce the amount of storage being used. Deduplication was useful at my old job when we found that several copies of large PowerPoint presentation files were present on our organization's SharePoint libraries, causing us to hit our 1TB storage max. Just by deleting the duplicates and consolidating our storage structure, we eliminated over 400 GB of duplicate videos, presentations, project files, and other large media files as well.

Q4. Provide an example where the features that eDiscovery Premium provides would be advantageous.

One of the features of eDiscovery (Premium) offers that is not included in the Standard version is

Source:

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/ediscovery-overview>

Q5. What impact does a "Hold" have? What does it do? How can the user tell if a hold has been put on some aspect of their account?

A 'Hold' preserves data related to a person, email, Teams site, etc. within a Microsoft 365 environment, even if a user tries to delete it. Holds are very impactful in eDiscovery because they can preserve data of interest for legal purposes. Holds also override retention or deletion policies.

Holds do not automatically notify a user that they are in place. An administrator or manager would have to explicitly tell the user. There is a feature in eDiscovery

Premium that an admin could send a notification email to a user, but it will not do so automatically.

Source:

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/ediscovery-managing-holds>

Q6. What is meta data? How is it used in eDiscovery?

Metadata is data about data - information that describes data and gives it context, such as creation date, file size, file type, email recipients, chat team/channel, message timestamps, file permissions, last user who accessed a file, etc.

In eDiscovery, metadata helps to sort out data to figure out what could be in scope. If there is an incident that has a definite timeline, any data outside of this timeline can be excluded from the eDiscovery, as it is out of scope. Likewise, if there is suspected illicit activity that was communicated about through email and chat exchanges between two individual users, any emails or chats between either user and someone else who isn't involved can be excluded as out of scope.

These examples show how metadata can greatly diminish the time it takes to complete eDiscovery.